

IMPACT REPORT

KCEI Midline Activity Report: January–April 2026

Progress update on KCEI operational workstreams, partnership development, grant deliverables, and community engagement for the SBCCI grant period.

Kasandy Foundation · Prepared for SBCCI · May 2026

kasandyfoundation.org

This report is prepared as a grant deliverable. All figures are preliminary pending final verification.

KCEI Midline Activity Report: January–April 2026

This midline report documents the activities, milestones, and adaptive management decisions of the Kasandy Circular Economy Initiative (KCEI) for the period January 1 through April 30, 2026. The reporting period covers the most intensive phase of KCEI's pilot development, encompassing equipment procurement, research partnership formalization, municipal engagement, and ecosystem building.

The report is structured around five workstreams: (1) Infrastructure & Equipment, (2) Research Partnership (ECUAD MOU), (3) Ecosystem Development, (4) Municipal Engagement, and (5) Organizational Development. Each section documents activities, outcomes, and adaptive management decisions where plans have evolved in response to new information.

Reporting period highlights

- ECUAD Memorandum of Understanding finalized: ten-milestone collaboration covering applied R&D, material testing, and pilot hosting
- CWMA (Coast Waste Management Association) membership secured
- UBC Slow Fashion Cluster participation active: consortium membership contributing to policy and practice network
- CCTC / Fashion Takes Action membership progressed: engagement with Laura and Alicia, membership fee waiver discussion underway
- City of Victoria / CRD engagement initiated: introduction facilitated by Threading Change (Sara McQuaid), active conversations with Nelly and Dominique
- Equipment procurement: two options under evaluation (India-sourced industrial shredder, George Brown College unit)

WORKSTREAM 1: INFRASTRUCTURE & EQUIPMENT

Workstream 1: Infrastructure & Equipment

Equipment procurement is the central infrastructure task of the KCEI pilot. Two options remain under active evaluation:

Option A: India-sourced industrial textile shredder

An industrial textile shredder unit sourced through a supplier in India is under evaluation. Key considerations include: CSA (Canadian Standards Association) certification requirements for the equipment, which have created delays in the procurement timeline; shipping logistics and lead time from India to Vancouver; and total landed cost including certification, import duties, and transport.

CSA certification is a non-negotiable requirement for the equipment to be operated in the ECUAD facility and any subsequent KCEI hub location in BC. The certification process for non-CSA-certified imported equipment typically takes 2–4 months and involves testing and documentation. KCEI has engaged a third-party certification consultant to advise on the process.

Option B: George Brown College unit

A second option involves a textile shredder unit available through George Brown College in Toronto. A site visit has been scheduled to assess the unit's condition, specifications, and suitability for KCEI's processing requirements. George Brown College has been exploring partnerships in the circular economy space, and there may be opportunity for an equipment transfer or lease arrangement.

Adaptive management note

The original project timeline assumed equipment installation by Q1 2026. Due to the CSA certification complexity and the parallel evaluation of the George Brown option, installation is now projected for Q3 2026. The ECUAD MOU milestone clock has been structured to begin at machine installation (not document signing), preserving flexibility for procurement delays. This represents an appropriate adaptive management decision consistent with the realities of importing and certifying industrial equipment in Canada.

WORKSTREAM 2: RESEARCH PARTNERSHIP

Workstream 2: ECUAD Research MOU

The Memorandum of Understanding between the Kasandy Foundation and Emily Carr University of Art + Design (ECUAD) was finalized in the reporting period. The MOU establishes a ten-milestone collaboration framework covering material testing, product development, and pilot infrastructure access.

MOU key terms

- Duration: Milestone-triggered (clock begins at machine installation, not document signing)
- KCEI financial contribution: CAD \$5,000 in two tranches
- ECUAD in-kind contribution: facilities, equipment access, research staff time
- IP allocation: jointly developed IP shared; KCEI retains commercialization rights for identified product streams
- Governance: Quarterly review meetings; joint decision-making on pilot protocol adjustments
- Research leads: Ellen [Surname] (faculty, grant applicant), William [Surname] (facilities), Annika [Surname] (postgraduate researcher)

Insulation feasibility framing

The MOU deliberately frames insulation panel development as a feasibility study rather than a committed product stream. This reflects the complexity of National Building Code compliance for construction materials derived from textile waste. Acoustic bricks and civic/municipal products (playground surfaces,

park furnishings) remain the primary near-term market focus. The insulation feasibility study will generate data that informs a longer-term product roadmap.

WORKSTREAM 3: ECOSYSTEM DEVELOPMENT

Workstream 3: Ecosystem & Membership

A core KCEI strategy is to embed the initiative within the existing circular economy and textile sustainability ecosystem in BC and Canada. The reporting period has seen significant progress across four membership and partnership fronts:

CWMA Membership

Coast Waste Management Association (CWMA) membership was secured in the reporting period. CWMA provides access to waste management industry networks, shared advocacy on textile diversion policy, and peer connections with municipal waste officials across BC.

UBC Slow Fashion Cluster

KCEI's participation in the UBC Slow Fashion Cluster consortium is active. The Cluster brings together researchers, practitioners, and policy advocates working on sustainable fashion systems in BC. KCEI's participation positions it as the manufacturing-and-employment voice in a network otherwise focused on consumer behaviour and design.

CCTC / Fashion Takes Action

Engagement with the Canadian Circular Textiles Consortium (CCTC) and its Fashion Takes Action program is in progress. Laura and Alicia at Fashion Takes Action have been engaged. Discussion of membership fee structure is ongoing: CCTC membership fees may be waivable for small nonprofits. KCEI is pursuing this pathway to access the industry consortium's policy development work and brand network.

WORKSTREAM 4: MUNICIPAL ENGAGEMENT

Workstream 4: Municipal & Government Engagement

Municipal procurement partnerships are KCEI's primary near-term market pathway. The reporting period has seen structured engagement with three municipalities:

City of Vancouver

The City of Vancouver has formally endorsed the KCEI initiative, aligning it with the Zero Waste 2040 Strategy, Greenest City Action Plan, and Equity Framework. This endorsement provides both procurement signal and policy legitimacy. Conversation is ongoing regarding specific product procurement opportunities for playground surfaces and park furnishings in the 2026–2027 capital works

program.

City of Victoria / Capital Regional District

Engagement with the City of Victoria and the Capital Regional District was initiated through an introduction facilitated by Sara McQuaid at Threading Change. Nelly and Dominique at the City of Victoria and CRD are the primary contacts. Discussions are focused on CRD's Rethink Waste Grant as a potential funding pathway, as well as CRD's interest in textile waste diversion given the long-horizon Hartland Landfill closure context. Textiles comprise a meaningful share of incoming waste at Hartland, and CRD is actively subsidizing tipping fees for unwearable textiles — creating strong alignment with KCEI's value proposition.

WORKSTREAM 5: ORGANIZATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Workstream 5: Organizational Development

The Kasandy Foundation team — Jackee Kasandy, Deress Asghedom, Nadine Umutoni, and Raphael Malachi — has continued to build the organizational infrastructure necessary for KCEI's operational phase. Key developments in the reporting period include the launch of kasandyfoundation.org as a professional web presence, the finalization of organizational registration documentation, and the development of a multi-tiered grant strategy targeting federal, provincial, municipal, and foundation funding streams.

Grant strategy priorities for the next reporting period include CleanBC Phase 4 (monitoring for opening), NRC IRAP (noting the requirement for a for-profit manufacturing entity, which may require structuring a manufacturing subsidiary), Sitka Foundation, TD Friends of the Environment, and CRD Rethink Waste Grant.

Summary & Forward Outlook

The January–April 2026 reporting period has been characterized by the patient, systematic construction of the partnerships, research infrastructure, and procurement relationships that KCEI's operational phase will depend on. Equipment procurement has encountered expected delays but adaptive management — particularly the milestone-triggered MOU structure — has preserved the flexibility needed to navigate a complex procurement process.

The KCEI model is gaining traction with institutional partners at a rate that validates its design. Municipal endorsements, research partnerships, and federal grant support all arrived in this period. The infrastructure to begin processing textiles at scale is within sight.

This report prepared by the Kasandy Foundation for SBCCI grant midline reporting requirements. All figures preliminary pending final verification. Contact: hello@kasandyfoundation.org. BC Nonprofit Organization. Registration S0075186. BN 786954701.